

Generated from the competition table

1978 FIFA World Cup

Everything the FIFA World Cup edition table records about 1978, with each placing linked to that team's full history.

Host(s)

Argentina

Teams

16

Winner

Argentina

Runner-up

Netherlands

Third

Brazil

Fourth / other semifinalist

Italy

Final

**Argentina 3-1
Netherlands (a.e.t.)**

Final date

25 June 1978

Top scorer

**Mario Kempes
(Argentina, 6 goals)**

All FIFA World Cup editions →



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 14 August 2026

- **FIFA tournament history and champions** (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1930-1978-uruguay-italy-germany-brazil-england-argentina>).

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- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights>)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argentina-sunday/>)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final>)
- ****One discrepancy found and fixed:**** the Final column read "Spain 1-0" (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760516/england-france)

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.